

Mario D. Molina

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

New York University Abu Dhabi

Assistant Professor, Social Research and Public Policy (2024 – Present).

New York University Abu Dhabi

Postdoctoral Associate, (2020 – 2024).

EDUCATION

Cornell University

2020. Ph.D in Sociology (*Minor in Statistics*)

Dissertation Committee: Michael W. Macy, Victor Nee, Filiz Garip, and Martin T. Wells.

2017. M.A., Sociology

Universidad Católica de Chile

2011. M.A., Sociology

Universidad de los Andes, Chile

2009. B.A., Philosophy

2008. B.A., Education

PUBLICATIONS

Molina, Mario D., Nancy Chau, Amanda Rodewald, and Filiz Garip (2023). “[How to model the weather-migration link: A machine-learning approach to variable selection in the Mexico-U.S. context.](#)” *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, 49(2): 465–491.

Molina, Mario, Victor Nee, and Hakan Holm (2023). “[Cooperation with strangers: Spillover of community norms.](#)” *Organization Science*, 34(6): 2315–2331.

Filiz Garip and Molina, Mario D. (2021). “[Network amplification](#)”, chapter 16, pp. 306-320. In *Research Handbook on Analytical Sociology*, Gianluca Manzo (ed.), Massachusetts, USA: Edward Elgar.

Molina, Mario D., Mauricio Bucca, & Michael Macy (2019). “[It’s not just how the game is played, it’s whether you win or lose.](#)” *Science Advances*, vol. 5, eaau1156.

Molina, Mario & Filiz Garip (2019). “[Machine learning for sociology.](#)” *Annual Review of Sociology*, vol. 45.

Molina, Mario (2013), “[Unity between Sensibility and Understanding. The Origin of the Critical Problem](#)”. *Revista de Filosofía*, vol. LXIX, 195-213.

WORKING PAPERS AND UNDER REVIEW (* denotes equal contribution)

Asad, Asad L.*, Amy Johnson* and Mario D. Molina*. “In Between: Structural Liminality, Group Threat, and Psychological Wellbeing among Latino U.S. Immigrants.” *Revise & Resubmit at the American Sociological Review*.

Molina, Mario D. “To Rest on One’s Laurels: Limits of Status Orders for Public Goods”. *Revise & Resubmit at the American Journal of Sociology*.

Bucca, Mauricio* and **Mario D. Molina***. “People Reject Unfairness but Normalize Inequality.”

Makovi, Kinga* and **Mario D. Molina***. “Evaluators as Moral Auditors: How Political Ideology Shapes Merit under Performance Uncertainty.”

Occhiutto, Nicholas and **Mario D. Molina**. “Brokering Price Bubbles: The Case of the Taxicab Medallion Bubble in New York City.”

Drouhot, Lucas, **Mario D. Molina**, and Filiz Garip. “Divided in Diversity? Majority-minority Ties and Cultural Difference in Friendship Networks among European Adolescents.”

WORK IN PROGRESS

Molina, Mario D. and Inna Smirnova. “The Effect of Negative Status Changes on Voluntary Contributions to a Large Q&A Community.”

Pan, Rui, **Mario D. Molina**, and Minsu Park. “The Price of Recognition: How Status Inequality and Hierarchical Stability Impact Creative Team Breakups.”

Bucca, Mauricio, Roberto Cantillan, **Mario D. Molina**, and Luca Maria Pesando. “Trickle-Down Names: How Social Class Shapes Naming Patterns.”

Molina, Mario D. “The Influence of High-status Individuals on Group-level Cooperation.”

Molina, Mario D. and Mauricio Bucca. “Are Inequality Concerns Contagious? The Effect of Descriptive Norms on Opportunity Beliefs.”

FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS, AND GRANTS

2022. Reserch Grant for the Project *How do conservatives and liberals apply fairness principles when they have information about group membership and the structure of economic opportunity?* (\$10,000). Social Science Division, New York University Abu Dhabi.

2019. Research Travel Grant for Dissertation project. (\$2,000). Graduate School, Cornell University.

2018. Seed Grant for the Project *The co-evolution of ingroup favoritism and group structure in online communities* (\$1,500). Center for the Study of Inequality, Cornell University.

2016. Research Grant for the Project *Talent, Circumstances, or Luck? An Experimental Approach to the Study of Beliefs about Inequality and Fairness*. (\$3,000). Center for the Study of Inequality, Cornell University.

2015. Seed Grant for the Project *Legitimation or Differential Perception? An Experimental Approach to the Study of Beliefs about Inequality*. (\$1,500). Center for the Study of Inequality, Cornell University.

WORKSHOPS AND ADDITIONAL TRAINING

NYU Abu Dhabi

2025. Frontiers of Network Science Workshop (*organizer and presenter*)

2023. Winter Institute in Computational Social Science (WICSS) (*organizer and presenter*).

ASA Annual Meeting

2022. Session on Computational Sociology (*organizer*).

Princeton University

2021. Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS, Summer).

Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research

2021. Topics in Digital and Computational Demography (Fall). *Declined*.

Santa Fe Institute

2019. Advanced Graduate Workshop in Computational Social Science (Summer).

2017. Graduate Workshop in Computational Social Science (Summer).

Facebook

2018. Research Scientist in the Demography and Survey Sciences team (Summer).

PRESENTATIONS (SELECTED)

“On the Margins: Liminal Group Memberships and Psychological Distress in the United States, 2011 to 201”

Identity Theory Conference at Purdue University (2025), RC45 Workshop (2026, *invited*)).

“To rest on one’s laurels: Limits of status orders for cooperation systems.”

Economic Sociology Conference at Rice University (2024), South Carolina Networks Consortium (2024), Universidad Catolica de Chile (2024), AOM Annual Meeting (2023), David Eccles School of Business (2023), ESMT Berlin (2022), NYU Abu Dhabi (2022), Ohio State University (2022), MPIDR (2022)), ASA Annual Meeting (2021).

“People reject unfairness but normalize inequality.”

4th Experimental Sociology Workshop (2024), IMEBESS Valencia (2025), ISA Forum RC25 (2025), ASA 2026, LSE (2026, *scheduled*)

“Unequal pay for unequal work? Uncertain performance and fairness in the workplace.”

ASA Annual Meeting (2023), Culture and Diversity Cluster at NYU Abu Dhabi (2023).

“Brokering price bubbles: The case of the taxicab medallion bubble in New York City.”

ESS Annual Meeting (2024), Economic Sociology Conference at Rice University (2024)

“The influence of high-status individuals on group-level cooperation.”

INAS Annual Meeting (2022).

“Machine Learning for Sociology.”

German Centre for Higher Education Research and Science Studies (DZHW) (2021, *invited*).

“How to model the weather-migration link: A machine-learning approach to variable selection in the Mexico-U.S. context.”

United Nations (2020, *invited*), Cornell University (2020, *invited lecturer*).

“Cooperation with strangers: Spillover of community norms.”

Organization Science Special Issue Conference, (2022, *online*), University of Notre Dame (2021, *invited*), Kellogg School of Management (2021, *invited*), University of Florida (2021, *invited*), C-BID at NYU Abu Dhabi (2021), CSES at Cornell University (2020).

“It’s not just how the game is played, it’s whether you win or lose.”

ASA Annual Meeting (2018), PAA Annual Meeting (2018), MIT (2016).

REVIEWER

American Sociological Review, American Journal of Sociology, Organization Science, European Sociological Review, Sociological Science, Social Forces, Sociological Methodology, Sociological Methods & Research, Demography, Social Science Research, Sociological Forum, Political Analysis, Socius, Plos One, Economic Modelling, Cities, AERA Open, AOM Annual Meetings (2023, 2024, 2025).

PROGRAMMING SKILLS

Python, R, Bash, PySpark, L^AT_EX, Git, Stata.